Entro Take-Home: Assumptions, Answers and Data Issues

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Summary

- FY26 book-to-burn is **1.01**: we won $15.41M and billed $15.26M, so the backlog held flat rather than grew.
- That result rests on one deal. Without the $1.63M Airports win in May 2026 (Client 369), FY26 would be 0.90. The rolling 12-month ratio was below 1.0 every month from July 2025 to April 2026.
- One modelling choice moves the answer below 1.0. Counting internal account 9999 as billing drops FY26 to 0.87. I excluded it.
- FY26 win % is 49.0%, but it blends original commissions (32.9%) and additional services (94.4%). Both rates rose versus FY25; the headline dipped from 50.9% only because the mix shifted toward original work.
- Monthly book-to-burn swings from 0.26 (Apr 2026) to 2.26 (May 2026), so I'd use the rolling 12-month line as the principal's headline, with the month shown for the record.

Answer Sheet

#	Question	Answer	Note (Assumption)
1	Won value, June 2026	**$1,487,320**	12 projects with Decision Date in June 2026, all phases. Won counted in its decision month (A4).
2	Book-to-burn, June 2026	**1.12**	$1,487,320 / $1,324,042 billed. 9999 excluded, credit notes netted (A3).
3	Book-to-burn, FY26	**1.01**	$15,412,840 / $15,264,752. FY26 = Jul 2025 to Jun 2026 (A3, A4).
4	Proposals submitted, March 2026	**47**	Rows with a Submitted Date, excluding No Go and In Pursuit (A2). 48 if those are counted.
5	Win % by count, FY26	**49.0%**	Of proposals submitted in FY26, Won / (Won + Lost)

			= 101 / 206. Pending (121) and Cancelled (7) excluded (A2).
6	Average proposal value, FY26	**$161,087**	Mean of 315 FY26 submissions with a value (19 blank). Median $75,250.
7	Writer B, Jan to Jun 2026: proposals submitted	**52**	Full credit on co-written proposals (A1). 44 if sole-written only.
8	Writer B, Jan to Jun 2026: win % by count	**39.1%**	9 won / 23 decided. 29 of 52 are still pending, so this can move a lot (A5).
9	Writer B, Jan to Jun 2026: average proposal value	**$219,775**	Mean of 51 proposals with a value (A1).

How the Answers Move if an Assumption Changes

Answer	My Choice	Alternative	Result
FY26 book-to-burn (1.01)	Exclude internal account 9999	Include it	0.87
FY26 book-to-burn	Net credit notes	Gross billing only	0.88
FY26 book-to-burn	All wins	Remove the single largest win	0.90
FY26 win % (49.0%)	Pending excluded	Pending counted as not won	30.2%
FY26 win %	Submission-date cohort	Decision-date cohort	40.4%

FY26 win %	All phases	Original commissions only	32.9%
Writer B win % (39.1%)	Decided only	All 29 pending lost / all won	17.3% / 73.1%

Stakeholder Questions and the Assumptions I Made

#	Question	Why the Answer Changes What I Build	Assumption I Made
A1	(Writer) When two or three writers share a proposal, does each get full credit?	Decides whether I need a writer bridge table, and whether writer totals should add to the company total.	Each credited writer gets full credit. Company totals count each proposal once, so writer rows sum to more than the total.
A2	(Writer) What counts as a submitted proposal, and is win % on decided proposals only?	Sets the row filter behind every proposal measure and the win % denominator.	Has a Submitted Date and is not No Go or In Pursuit. Win % = Won / (Won + Lost) on the submission-month cohort.
A3	(Principal) Should billing include internal account 9999 and credit notes?	Changes the book-to-burn direction (1.01 vs 0.87).	9999 excluded as intercompany. Credit notes netted: 287 of 323 are same-day reversals of a reissued invoice.
A4	(Principal) Is work won on the decision date, and what about 15 Won projects ($10.66M) with no Decision Date?	Sets the date relationship for Won Value; these 15 would add $10.66M to whichever month they belong to.	Won on the Decision Date. Undated wins kept out of monthly figures and listed separately.
A5	(Both) How soon after submission is a win rate reliable, and how often will you read this?	Recent months are mostly undecided, so a raw win % for them misleads.	Win % is shown only once at least 10 proposals are decided (monthly and rolling 6-month), with the decided count beside it. Monthly refresh.

Data Issues (Largest Impact First)

1. **Internal account 9999.IC02.00:** 708 invoice lines, $4.63M. Its status is Won, so a “Won only” filter does not remove it. Excluded by Project ID and kept in a separate query as evidence.
2. **15 Won projects with no Decision Date ($10.66M):** They never land in a month, so they are listed on their own rather than guessed into a period.
3. **Writer data is reliable only from October 2025:** Writer is blank on 71% of rows (coverage 27% in Jul to Sep 2025, 75% in Jan to Jun 2026). 20 rows hold several comma-separated writers; splitting leaves a leading space on 21 names. Without a Trim step, Writer B shows 48 proposals instead of 52.
4. **Status values differ from the brief:** “Withdrawn” does not appear. 30 No Go and 18 In Pursuit rows carry a Submitted Date; both are excluded from Proposals Submitted. I would confirm that No Go means withdrawn.
5. **Credit notes and apparent duplicates:** 323 negative lines, mostly reversing a same-day invoice that was reissued. Duplicate-looking lines are mostly already reversed, so I kept them; removing them would cut FY26 billing by $0.32M and push book-to-burn to 1.03.
6. **History before July 2024 holds only Won projects:** Win % is measured only on proposals submitted from July 2024.
7. **Currency:** Project values use one current exchange rate, invoices the invoice-date rate. The USA office is 32% of FY26 won value, so I read 1.01 as flat rather than growing.
8. **Invoices start in July 2024:** A lifetime backlog cannot be measured without an opening balance.

Model and What I Would Build Next

Data Model

Fact_Proposals, Fact_Invoices, a fiscal Dim_Date (July to June), and a writer bridge with Dim_Writer.

- Won Value uses the Decision Date and proposal measures the Submitted Date, each via USERELATIONSHIP.
- Billed Value uses the Invoice Date.
- The writer page works for any writer through the bridge.
- Writers are compared with an original-commissions benchmark (about 32% since July 2024), because they mostly write original proposals. Against the blended 50% benchmark, Writer B looked 12.5 points behind; like for like, Writer B is 5.5 points ahead.
- The principal page shows Won Value, Billed Value and book-to-burn, monthly and rolling 12-month.

First Week Priorities

1. Data Quality

- Fix at source, not in the report: a flag for internal accounts, mandatory Decision Date on wins, writers in a structured field instead of comma text, and a confirmed No Go and withdrawn mapping.

2. Principal Dashboard

- Rolling 12-month book-to-burn as the headline, with a tooltip showing the largest deal’s share of each month.

3. Writer Dashboard

- A pending list sorted by age and value, since proposals open past 90 days win far less often.

4. Finance Reporting

- An opening backlog balance and native-currency values, so backlog and book-to-burn can be stated precisely.